he had viewed the property and bought it. He was emailing to say thanks, !along with asking for my letting agents details. Wow

Five-point checklist

There are lots to consider when investing in any property, particularly an .HMO, but it pretty much boils down to five things

Area

People are looking for rooms everywhere, but as I mentioned earlier it has to be close to a centre. Wherever there are centres there are offices, shops, people, jobs and a buzz. It isn't your property that is going to give you an .income, but the people who live there

I typically work on the basis that the property has to be located within 15 minutes of a town centre for those without a car. If it's in a quiet cul-de-sac five miles out of town, it will not work. If it's on a main road with regular buses that take you to town within ten minutes, you might be on to .something

Good condition

The mortgage company will not lend money for you to do the house up. If you have to spend a £20,000 renovation on the house, that could have been .the deposit on another whole house

The less you have to spend on the house the better, because then your .money will go further

I usually expect to spend a few thousands on carpets and paint, and then legally you may have to make a few amendments to make sure the house is safe as an HMO. But please don't spend much on refurbishments unless you know you can pull your money out later. Another reason I avoid refurbishments is because everything always costs more than you plan and